

# **2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA**

**NAME:** \_\_\_\_\_

**DATE OF BIRTH:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Please circle your age group:**

- U8 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U10 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U12 (born after 1/1/2018!!)

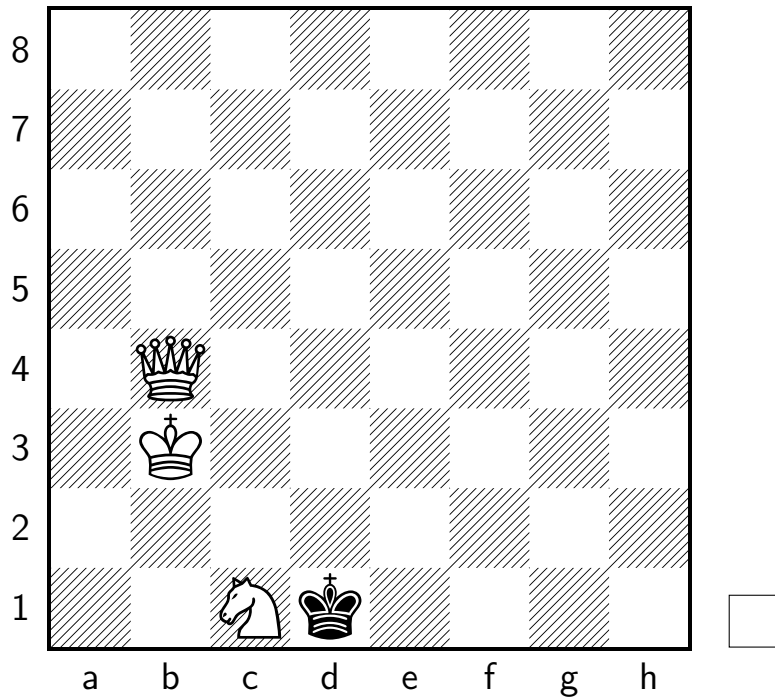
**Please circle: Boy or Girl**

**Please read the following rules.**

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, try to show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

**Enjoy the problem solving.**

**Q1. Mate in two.**



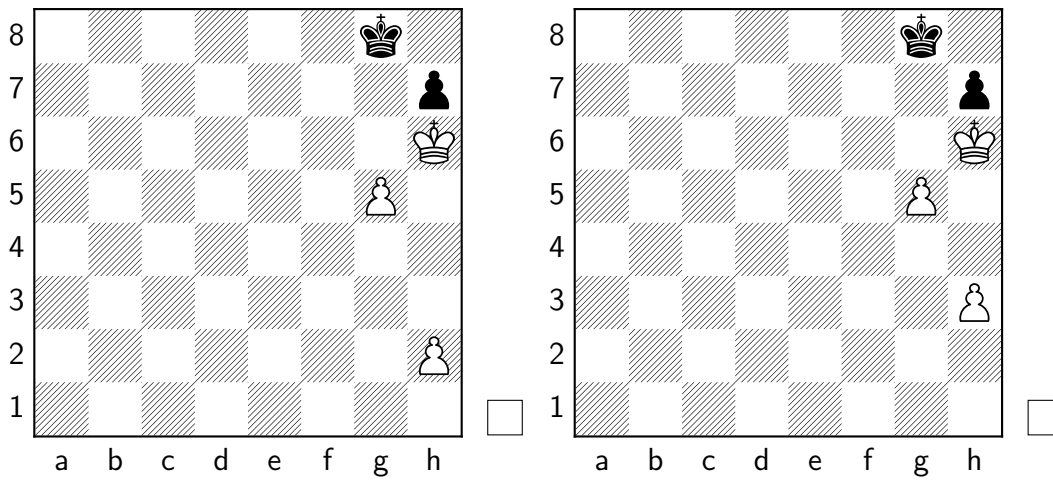
**Answer:**

1 ♔a5 ♕xc1 2 ♚e1#

**Intention:** Waiting move, forced move (Easy warm-up)

**Source:**

**Q2.** Is there any difference between left and right?



**Answer:**

White wins in left and draws in right.

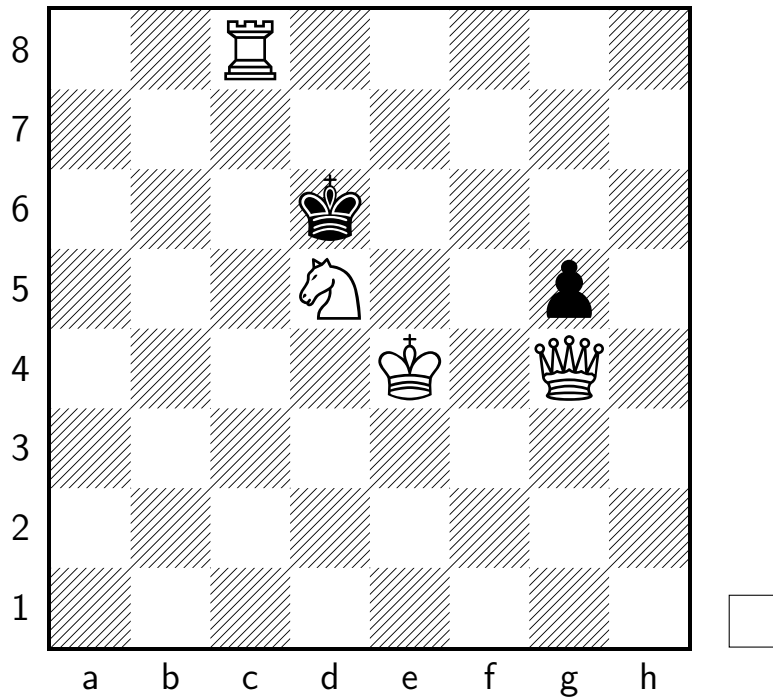
White wins as follow.

1 h3 ♔h8 2 h4 ♔g8 3 h5 ♔h8 4 g6 h×g6 5 h×g6 ♔g8 6 g7

Intention: endgame, tempo (Easy warm-up)

Source: Theoretical endgame

Q3. Mate in two.



Answer:

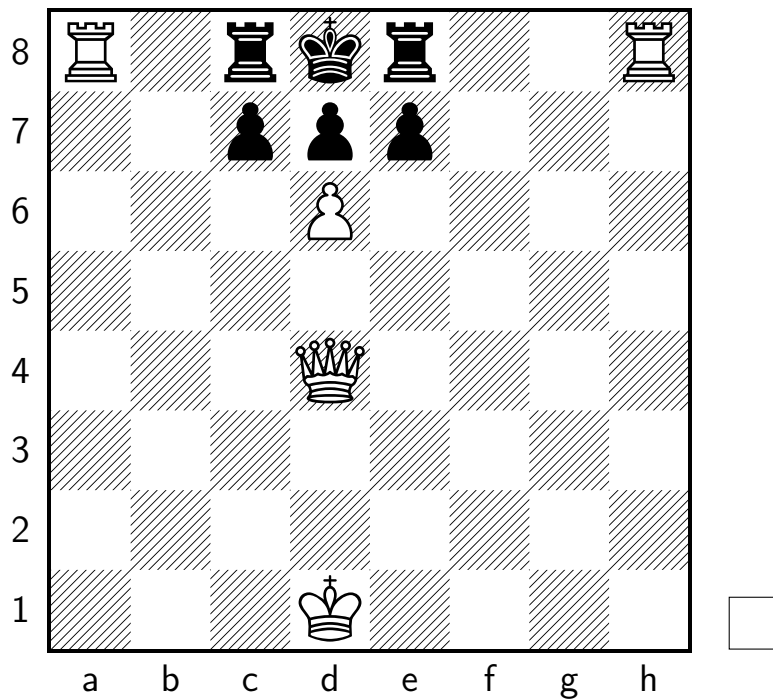
1 ♔f5 ♔d7 2 ♔e7#

1 ♔f5 ♔xd5 2 ♕d1#

Intention: King move (Easy warm-up)

Source: Samuel Loyd

Q4. Mate in two.



Answer:

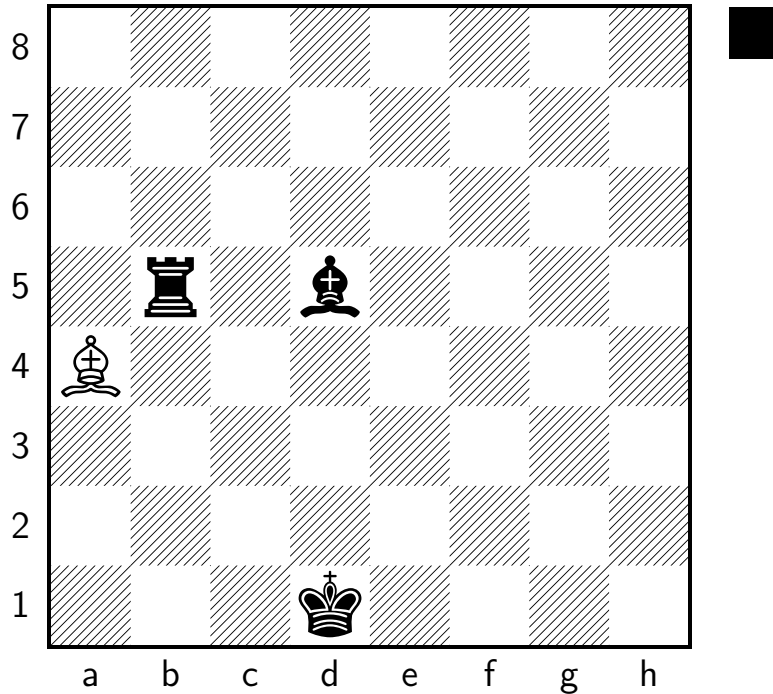
1 ♔c3 ♖xh8 2 ♔xh8#  
 1 ♔c3 ♖xh8 2 ♔xh8#  
 1 ♔c3 c6/c5 2 ♔a5#  
 1 ♔c3 cxd6 2 ♔xc8/Rxc8/Qa5#  
 1 ♔c3 e6 2 ♔xc8/Qf6#  
 1 ♔c3 e5 2 ♔xc8#  
 1 ♔c3 exd6 2 ♔f6#

1 ♔a1 (unsuccessful with 1...e5!)

Intention: Queen move (Medium?)

Source: Peter Wong, Chess in Australia 1988

Q5. This board is missing one piece. Answer the piece and its position, then write down the last few moves.



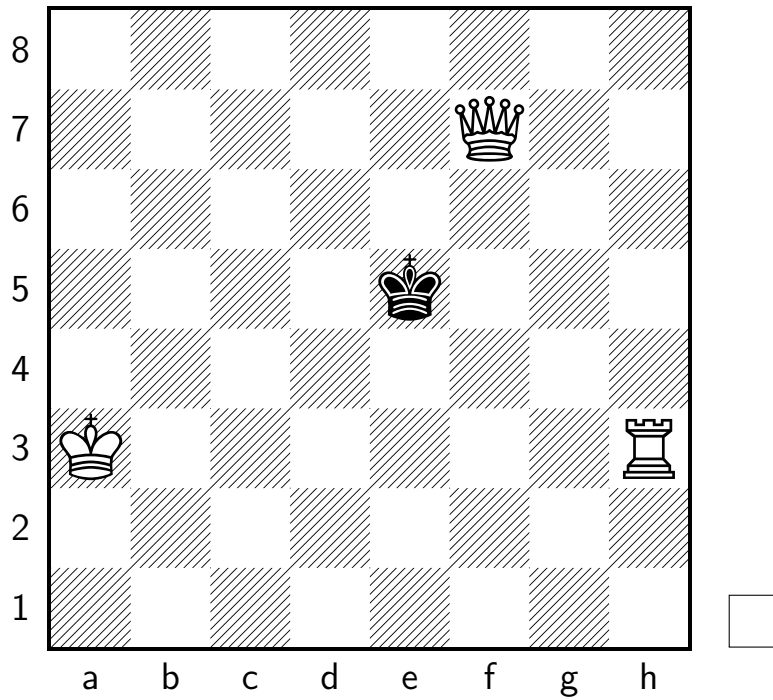
Answer:

1... ♖d5+  
 2 c4... bxc3+  
 3 ♔xc3+

Intention: Retrograde analysis, en passant (Medium?)

Source: Raymond M. Smullyan: The Chess Mysteries of the Arabian Knights

**Q6. Mate in 3.**



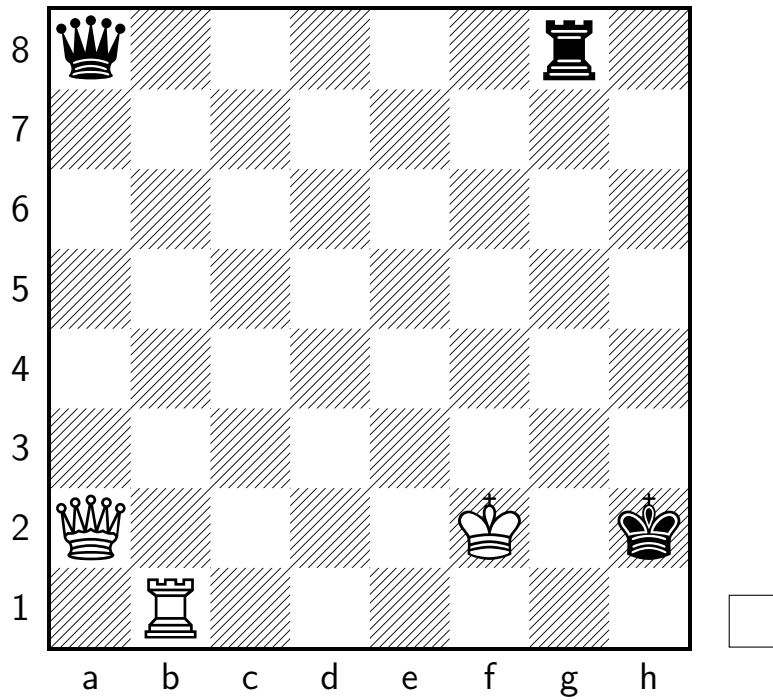
**Answer:**

1... ♔d5+  
2 c4... bxc3+  
3 ♔xc3+

**Intention:** Retrograde analysis, en passant (Medium?)

**Source:**

Q7. Show a winning sequence.



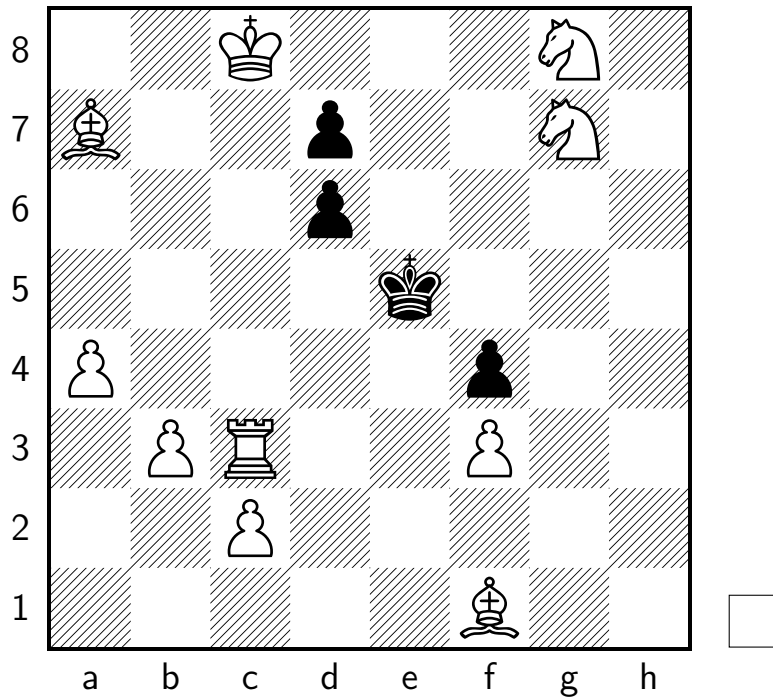
Answer:

1 ♖h1+! ♔xh1 2 ♕xg3  
 1 ♖h1+! ♔xh1 2 ♕b1+ ♖g1 3 ♕h7#

Intention: Sacrifice (Easy?)

Source:

Q8. Mate in three.



Answer:

1 ♕g2! ♔d5 2 ♖e3 fxe3 3 f4#

1 ♕g2! ♔d5 2 ♖e3 ♕c6 3 ♘e7#

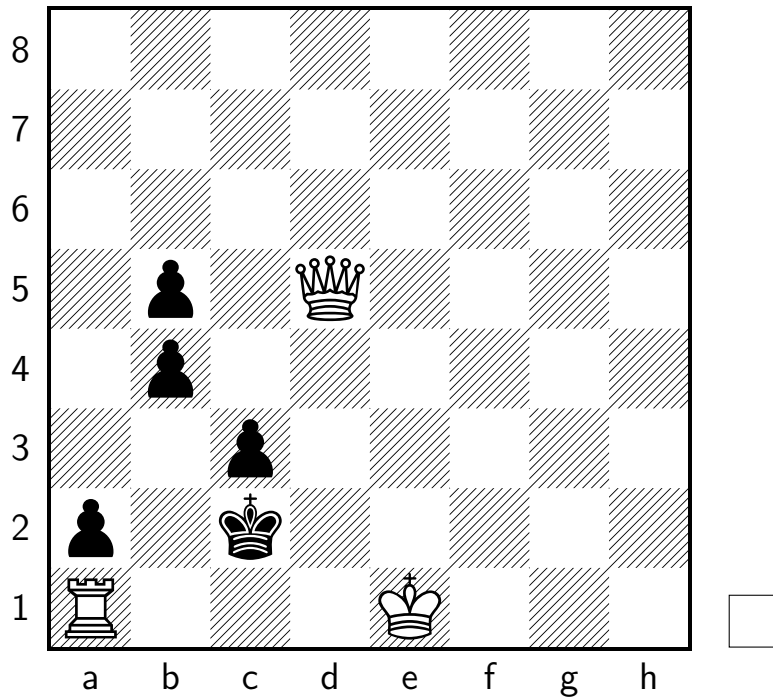
1 ♕g2! d5 2 ♕xd7 d4 3 ♖c5#

1 ♕d7 d5 2 ♖d3+ ♕e5 3 ♕c6 d5 4 ♖d5# (takes 4 moves)

Intention: Counterintuitive 1st move (Medium?)

Source: Thomas Denton Clarke, The Brisbane Courier 1918

Q10. Mate in two.



Answer:

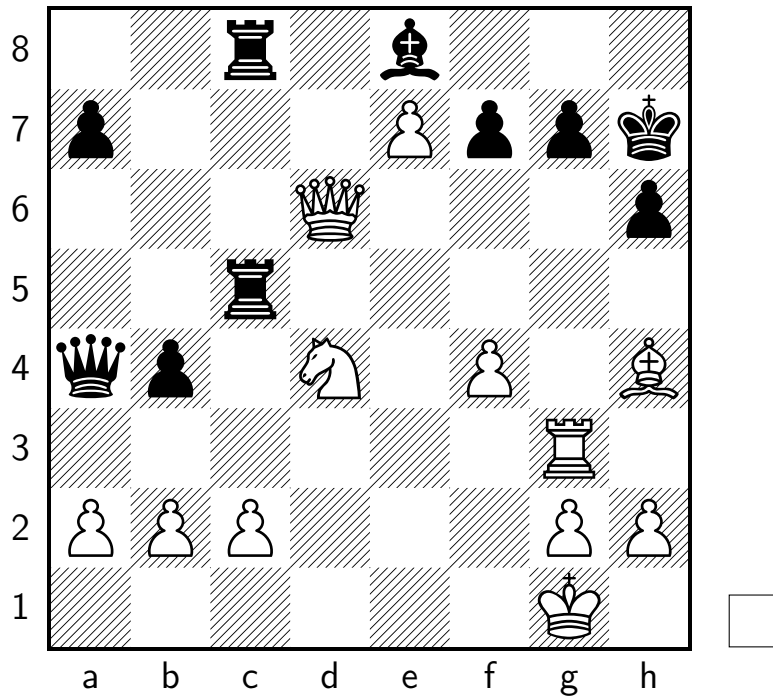
1 ♔e6! ♚d3 2 ♖a0-0-0#

Intention: Waiting move, castling (Medium?)

Source: William Whyatt

QXX. Mate in eight.

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025)



Answer:

1 ♖xg7+! ♔xg7 2 ♕f6+ ♔g8 3 ♞e6 fxe6 4 ♕f8+ ♔h7 5 ♘f6 ♖g5 6 f×g5 ♙g6 7 g4 ♕xc3 8 ♕g7#

Daniel Naroditsky is an American grand master, and he is famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.

Intention: Might be long, but straightforward (Medium?)

Source: Daniel Naroditsky - Timur Gareyev 2020